



**RENOVATION WORK
AT THE TAJ MAHAL
HOTEL, MUMBAI**

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in the politics of hate, is busy creating the ghetto-friendly phantom of the pure Mumbaikar. Even as P. Chidambaram plays no-nonsense warrior minister in Delhi, Ajmal Amir Kasab, the living face of the horror of 26/11, gets accustomed to the comforting maze of the Indian judicial system. For a sentimental subplot, there is Kavita Karkare, the widow of the daredevil ATS chief Hemant Karkare, still wanting to know why her husband had to die. On the diplomatic front, the mandarins of North Block may continue to prepare dossier after dossier on the architects of 26/11, but the masterminds of the attack are well protected by a Pakistan that is now used to the weaklings of Delhi. Today, as David Headley hogs headlines as the latest twist in the Mumbai plot, it further exposes the holes in our intelligence network.

The Americans did the work.

And post-9/11 America knows the worth of such work. We never get tired of saying 26/11 is our 9/11. There is a huge difference. On September 12, America was not a divided country engrossed in a self-defeating blame game. It was a country united by anger and patriotism—a much-maligned word in this part of the world. There was no red America or blue America then, there was only a nation in sorrow but determined not to give in to the enemies of civilisation. As *Le Monde* famously said in its editorial, “We are all Americans today”. One year after the infamy, India, divided by politics, doesn’t know what to do with its enemy or with its much-mauled nationalist soul. We are as clueless as we were on that dreadful November night one year ago. ■